

Tax-Aide Activity Logging System : User Manual

Chapter 1: System Overview & General Concepts

1.1 Purpose of the System

Welcome to the AARP Tax-Aide Activity Logging and Tax Return Tracking System, a multi-site system designed as a collaborative tool for all AARP Tax-Aide volunteers engaged in providing tax preparation services. The primary goal in developing this system was to make the management and tracking of the tax preparation process at all Tax-Aide sites easy and error-free compared with activity logging systems used today, while providing leadership at the site and district level with real-time status of the tax returns prepared by AARP Tax-Aide volunteers.

The system logs, tracks, documents and archives all activities of the tax preparation process from taxpayers' appointments and check-in to the successful filing of their tax return, recording all steps taken during this process by all volunteers as well as all exceptions that occur while providing tax preparation services to thousand of clients.

The system supplements rather than replaces the limited status logging features provided by TaxSlayer, enabling AARP Tax-Aide volunteers to better manage the workflow during the tax filing season.

1.2 User Roles and Responsibilities

All AARP Tax-Aide volunteers engaged in providing tax preparation services access and collaborate by using the system. Those include:

- Client Facilitators (Greeters)
- Tax Counselors
- Quality Reviewers
- Shift Coordinators
- Local Coordinators (site leaders)
- District Administrator
- District Coordinator

This user manual will address the responsibilities of each of these roles and the procedures to be used by them.

1.3 Accessing the System Using Google Workspace

The system is hosted on the AARP-provided Google Workplace using Google Sheets that embed Apps Scripts (GAS).

After logging into their Chromebook in the normal manner, the volunteer launches the system using the "Activity Logging" link provided on the Chrome browser's bookmark bar. No additional login is required.

In some cases the Google Workspace will require the user to go through a one-time procedure that enables the user to run the scripts associated with the system operation. If this occurs, please consult the District Technology Coordinator who will walk you though the procedure.

The system may also be accessed using a user's PC, provided that the network being used meets AARP Tax-Aide's security requirements. Please consult the District Technology Coordinator if you wish to access the system from a non-AARP network.

1.4 The Tax Preparation Workflow

The overall process tracked by the system during a Tax-Aide shift is depicted in Figure 1.

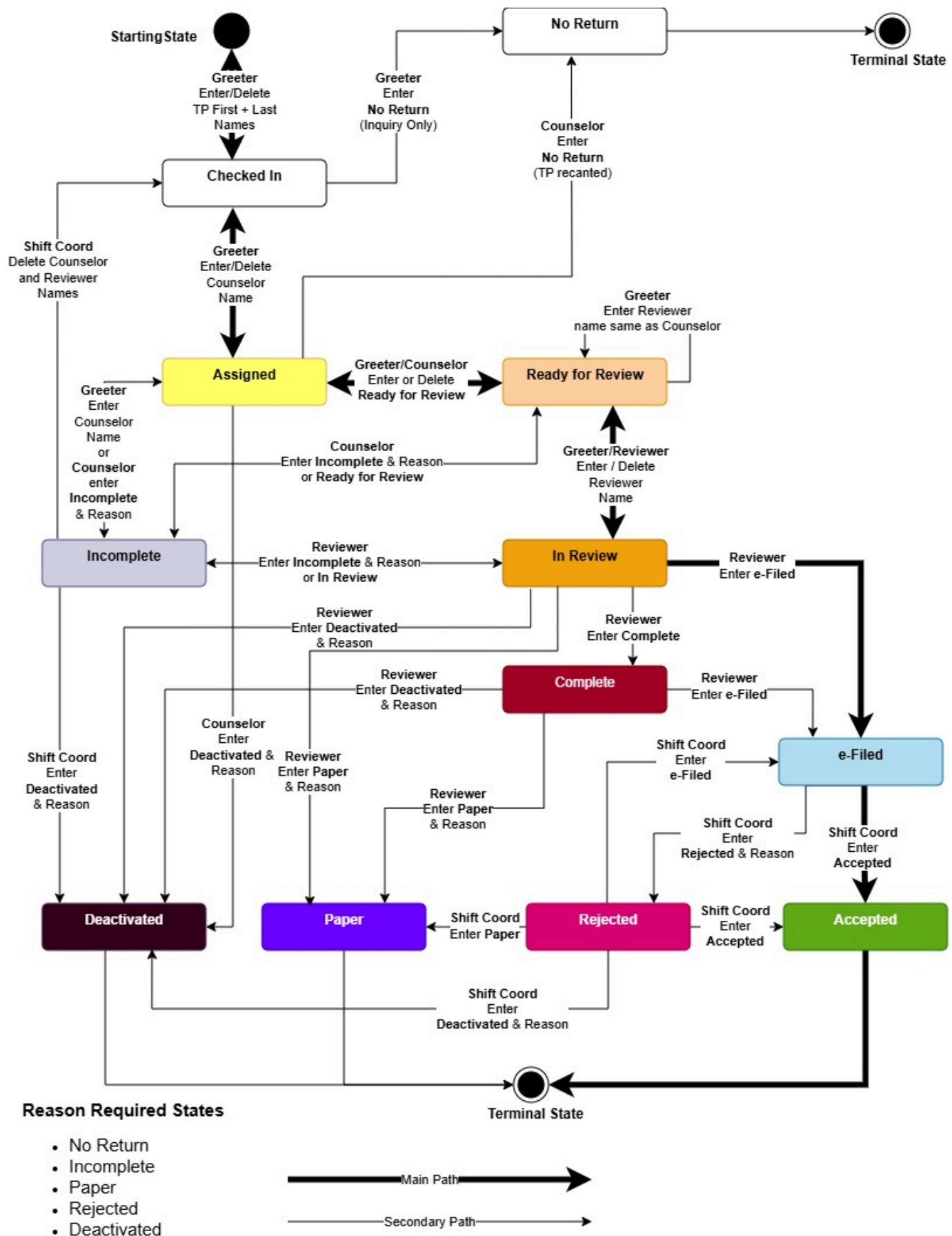


Figure 1 - The Tax-Aide Tax Preparation Workflow

The diagram shows all possible states of a tax return as well as all permitted transitions from one state to the next. Transitions that are not shown by connections are deemed invalid. The workflow represented by this

diagram is typical of all Tax-Aide sites that operate in the traditional, in-person service model. It is not designed for other service delivery models offered by the AARP Tax-Aide program.

At sites that operate by appointment, there is a preliminary process of transferring the daily appointments from the AARP Session Management or other appointment-making system into the Tax-Aide Activity Logging and Tax Return Tracking System. This process will be described later in this manual.

An additional process, executed at the end of a day's shift deals with the archiving of completed and uncompleted tax returns.

The process begins by the taxpayer reporting to the Tax-Aide tax preparation site and met by a greeter (Support or Client Facilitator in AARP-speak) who checks them in by validating their identity and entering their information into the system. It always ends in one of four "terminal" states from which the system will not permit further transition. Those are:

- **Accepted:** A tax return that was electronically filed (e-filed) and accepted by the IRS.
- **Paper:** A tax return that was prepared for the taxpayer to be filed by mail. A paper tax return is never e-filed.
- **Deactivated:** A tax return that was deactivated in the TaxSlayer system.
- **No Return:** The taxpayer and/or the Tax-Aide volunteer decided not to begin the process of preparing a tax return. A No Return means that a tax return was not begun in TaxSlayer.

All other states are various stages of an incomplete tax preparation process and include:

- **Checked In:** A taxpayer has checked in and is waiting for their return to be prepared by a counselor.
- **Assigned:** The tax return is assigned to a counselor and is in the process of being prepared.
- **Ready for Review:** The tax return preparation by a counselor was completed and is ready to be reviewed by a quality reviewer.
- **In Review:** The tax return is in the process of being reviewed by a quality reviewer.
- **Complete:** The tax return has been completed and reviewed, but has not yet been e-filed or provided to the taxpayer in paper form.
- **e-Filed:** The tax return was electronically filed with the IRS.
- **Rejected:** The electronically filed tax return has been rejected by the IRS.
- **Incomplete:** The tax return is incomplete, is not actively being prepared or reviewed and awaiting further action by a taxpayer and/or a tax-Aide volunteer.

For the following states the system enforces stating a reason for the tax return being assigned this state by popping up a form as in Figure 2. The reason may be a combination of a preset, typical reason and/or free text entered by the operator. The reason will be recorded in the comments section of the tax return record. This requirement is important for maintaining communications amongst volunteers regarding the state of the tax return, as it may be handled by several volunteers with different roles over the course of several days. It may also be important in cases where a review of an interaction between taxpayers and volunteers are necessary.

- **Rejected**
- **Incomplete**
- **No Return**
- **Deactivated**
- **Paper**

Reason Required

×

Reason for Incomplete

Select a reason:

Missing documents

▼

And/Or enter free-form explanation:

Taxpayer still waiting for 1099-INT

Submit

Cancel

Figure 2 - The Reason Required Form

1.5 Status Tracking

It is important to note that the system keeps track of every transition from one state to another. It does so in a background process which is not visible to the system operators. This data is stored in three hidden and protected tabs - DB_Tax>Returns, DV_History_Log and DB_Volunteers. Do not try to manipulate the data in these tabs. The information gathered by status tracking is processed and displayed on the system's other tabs in a variety of ways.

Chapter 2: The Check In Process

2.1 Checking In Scheduled Taxpayers

This section is only applicable to sites operating by appointment.

Prior to the daily session, a Session Management Coordinator populates the Appointments tab of the system with the day's appointments. This process will be described later in this manual. The Appointments tab is shown in Figure 2.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Appointment Time	First Name	Last Name	Phone Number	Check In	Checked In Time
2	1:00 PM	Arthur	Pendelton	(941) 555-0143	☐	
3	1:15 PM	Beatrice	Vance	(941) 555-0187	☐	
4	1:30 PM	Calvin	Hobbs	(813) 555-0122	☐	
5	1:45 PM	Diana	Cruz	(941) 555-0195	☐	
6	2:00 PM	Evan	Montgomery	(813) 555-0151	☐	
7	2:15 PM	Fiona	Gallagher	(407) 555-0176	☐	
8	2:30 PM	George	Brooks	(941) 555-0119	☐	
9	2:45 PM	Hannah	Abbott	(407) 555-0164	☐	
10	3:00 PM	Ian	Malcolm	(813) 555-0138	☐	
11						

+ ≡ Dashboard ▾ Activity_Log ▾ Incomplete ▾ Archive ▾ **Appointments ▾** No Shows ▾

Figure 3 -The Appointment Tab

When a taxpayer is welcomed at the tax preparation site, the greeter confirms the taxpayer's identity and checks the **Check In** checkbox next to the taxpayer name. The system will then timestamp the taxpayer's arrival date and time and transfer the tax return record to the Activity Log tab and confirm as follows:

Taxpayer Checked In

Name: ARTHUR PENDELTON

Checked in at: 07/21/2026 09:43 PM



Figure 4 -Checked In Confirmation

After transferring the record to the Activity Log tab, the system will delete the appointment record from the Appointment tab. The fields transferred to the Activity Log tab include the taxpayer's first and last names (capitalized) and the time they checked in. The system then focuses on the row in the Activity_Log tab to which the appointment was transferred. The greeter may then add the primary taxpayer's last 4 digits of their Social Security number, if required by the site standard operating procedures. The system enters the tax year which by default is the current tax year (e.g 2026 for tax returns prepared in early 2027). The volunteer may choose a different tax year from the dropdown. If the taxpayer wishes to prepare tax returns for more than

one year, the greeter should enter each year as a separate record, as each tax return is tracked separately as described in section 2.2 below.

2.2 Handling Walk-In Taxpayers

At sites operating on a first-come / first served basis or appointment sites that accept walk-in taxpayers, the greeter enters the taxpayer's information directly into the Activity_Log tab. This information includes:

- First name(s) (mandatory)
- Last name(s) (mandatory)
 - If the tax return is being prepared for married couples, enter the first and last names of the primary taxpayer.
- As soon as the first and last names are entered into the Activity_Log tab, the system records the Check In Time and set the Status of the return to "Checked In".
 - The system also starts a duration counter, updated every minute, counting the time the taxpayer is being processed.
- The last 4 digits of the primary taxpayer's Social Security number
 - If required by the site leadership.
 - Inclusion or exclusion of the SSN Last 4 column on the Activity_Log tab is controlled by the site's settings.
- Ticket #
 - Ticket numbers are used at walk-in sites to control the first-come/first-served queuing system
 - Inclusion or exclusion of the Ticket # column on the Activity_Log tab is controlled by the site's settings.
- Tax Year
 - By default, the system enters the current tax year. A volunteer may change the tax year to any of the tax years permitted.
 - When a taxpayer request preparation of more than one year of tax returns, every year must be entered as a separate record.

Once the taxpayer's first and last names are entered into the Activity Log tab, the system will capitalize the taxpayer's first and last name, timestamp the check in time and set the status of the return to **Checked In**. See Figure 5.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	10:11 PM	1	1234	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026			Checked In		1 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											

Figure 5 - Checking In a Taxpayer on the Activity Log Tab

2.3 The Duration Indicator

The moment the taxpayer has checked in, a clock starts, showing the duration the taxpayer has been on site under the Duration header of the Activity_Log tab. The clock updates every minute. The clock continues to advance while the tax return is in any of the following states: **Checked In, Assigned, Ready for Review** or **In Review**. The clock stops when the return reaches any of the following states: **e-Filed, Complete, Paper, Accepted, Deactivated, No Return** or **Incomplete**.

The background color of the duration changes to alert the volunteers of a process that maybe too long. By default it stays green up to 45 minutes, orange between 45 and 90 minutes and red above 90 minutes. Those times may be set differently in the Setting tab by a system administrator.

Chapter 3: The Tax Preparation Process

As per IRS and AARP policy, every tax return should be prepared by a certified counselor and reviewed by another certified reviewer. The system enforces this policy by presenting two dropdown lists, one for counselors and one for reviewers. The system will not permit the assignment of the same volunteer as counselor and quality reviewer. The names of the certified counselors and reviewers are electronically pushed into the system by the District Administration Coordinator whose role is to oversee the certification process.

3.1 The Tax Counselor's Guide

When the taxpayer is ready to be seen by a counselor, the greeter will introduce the taxpayer to the counselor. The greeter will then select the counselor's name from the dropdown list. The system will change the status of the tax return from **Checked In** to **"Assigned"**. The row will be highlighted in yellow. See Figure 5.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	10:11 PM	1	1234	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor		Assigned		6 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 6 - Assigning a Counselor

While the Counselor is preparing the tax return with the taxpayer, the status remains **"Assigned"**. Once a counselor has completed the preparation of the tax return, they must change the status to **Ready for Review**, indicating that a reviewer may pick up the return for review and completion. The system will highlight the row in light orange. See Figure 6.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	10:11 PM	1	1234	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor		Ready for Review		863 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 7 - Ready for Review

3.2 The Quality Reviewer's Guide

Tax-Aide Quality Reviewers are experienced tax counselors who are authorized by their Local Coordinator (site leader) to review tax returns prepared by counselors. Typically, quality reviewers also act as Electronic Return Originators (EROs) who are authorized to e-file a tax return with the IRS. This manual assumes that a quality reviewer is also an ERO.

Once a quality reviewer is assigned to the tax return by picking a quality reviewer name from the Reviewer column, the system will automatically change the status of the tax return to **In Review**, highlighting the row in brown. See Figure 8.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	1:31 PM		1234	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	In Review		1 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 8 - In Review

While the quality reviewer is reviewing the tax return with the taxpayer, the status remains **"In Review"**. Once a quality reviewer has completed the review of the tax return, the next step is typically to go over the completed return with the taxpayer and obtain their written consent for electronically filing the return with the IRS using IRS form 8879. Once the consent was obtained and the tax return e-filed, the quality reviewer marks the return as e-filed and the system will highlight the row in cyan. See Figure 9.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	1:31 PM		1234	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	e-Filed		22 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 9 - e-Filed

3.3 Handling Exceptions

Some cases do not follow the most common workflow from **Checked In** to **Assigned** to **Ready for Review** to **In Review** and to **e-filed**. The tax counselor, quality reviewer or the taxpayer may decide that a different flow is appropriate. With the consent of the shift coordinator the system will support handling such exceptions as described in the following sections. Figure 1 depicts all the possible state transitions, including these exceptional cases.

3.3.1 No Return

In some cases, during the initial discussion with the taxpayer, the client facilitator, counselor or taxpayer may reach the conclusion that a tax return should not be prepared at all. Typical examples of **No Return** are "Out of Scope" returns or taxpayer's inquiries. It is important to capture and record all **No Return** cases due to host site requirements and AARP Foundation directives. If the tax return has not yet been started in TaxSlayer, the counselor will assign a status of **"No Return"** and state the reason for this decision - see Figure 2. The system will highlight the row in white. See Figure 10. As the **No Return** state is terminal, the system will immediately transfer the record from the Activity Log to the Archive tab.

Reason Required

Reason for No Return

Select a reason:
Out of Scope

And/Or enter free-form explanation:
Has rental property

Submit Cancel

Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
3:32 PM		3456	JOHN	DOE	2026	Mr. Counselor		No Return		1 min

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 10 - No Return

If a tax return was already started in TaxSlayer, do not use a **No Return** status. Use a **Deactivated** state instead.

3.3.2 Incomplete

Should the quality reviewer determine that the tax return cannot be completed at this time, but the taxpayer intends to come back and complete the tax return, they should mark the status as **"Incomplete"** and state the reason for the incompleteness - see Figure 2. **Incomplete** tax returns will be swept from the Activity Log tab into the Incomplete tab at the end of the day through the End-of-Day process described in section 4.3 of this manual. The system will highlight the row in grey. See Figure 11.

Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments
3:06 PM		2345	BEATRICE	VANCE	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Incomplete	Missing documents. Waiting for 1099-INT from Schwab

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows

Figure 11 - Incomplete

3.3.3 Deactivated

After the tax preparation process has begun in TaxSlayer, the counselor, quality reviewer and taxpayer may decide to abandon the tax return. In this case the volunteer marks the status as **"Deactivated"**, states the reasons - see Figure 2 - and deactivates the return in TaxSlayer. Typical examples of reasons for deactivation are "Out of Scope" returns, taxpayer's preference or simply a taxpayer that never returned to complete their tax return before the end of the tax season. Since **Deactivated** is a terminal state, the system will immediately transfer the tax return from the Activity_Log tab into the Archive tab. The system will highlight the row in black. See Figure 12.

The screenshot shows a web application interface with a data table and a modal dialog box. The table has columns: Check In Time, Ticket #, SSN Last 4, First Name, Last Name, Tax Year, Counselor, Reviewer, Status, Comments, and Duration. The first row shows a ticket for 4:08 PM, SSN 3564, BEATRICE VANCE, Tax Year 2026, Counselor Mr. Counselor, Reviewer (blank), Status Deactivated, and Duration 4 min. A modal dialog box titled 'Reason Required' is open, asking for a reason for deactivating. It has a dropdown menu for 'Select a reason:' with 'Lost contact with taxpayer' selected, and a text area for 'And/Or enter free-form explanation:' with the text 'Taxpayer never came back to finish their return'. There are 'Submit' and 'Cancel' buttons at the bottom of the dialog.

Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
4:08 PM		3564	BEATRICE	VANCE	2026	Mr. Counselor		Deactivated		4 min

Figure 12 - Deactivated

3.3.4 Complete

In some cases, although the tax return has been completed and reviewed, the taxpayer does not wish to file it at that time. The quality reviewer has the option of assigning it the status of **Complete**, which will keep the tax return in this state until the taxpayer decides how they want to proceed. **Complete** tax returns will be swept from the Activity Log tab into the Incomplete tab at the end of the day through a process described later in this manual. The system will highlight the row in purple. See Figure 13.

The screenshot shows the same data table as Figure 12, but the second row is highlighted in purple. This row shows a ticket for 4:26 PM, SSN 7854, JOE DOE, Tax Year 2026, Counselor Mr. Counselor, Reviewer Ms. Reviewer, Status Complete, and Duration 1 min. The modal dialog box is no longer present.

Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
4:26 PM		7854	JOE	DOE	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Complete		1 min

Figure 13 - Completed

3.3.5 Paper

While most tax returns handled by the Tax-Aide program are filed electronically, there are circumstances where the taxpayer must file a paper return. After seeking the approval of the shift coordinator, the quality reviewer may print the tax return, hand it to the taxpayer and assign the tax return the status of **Paper** in the system. The system will require the quality reviewer to state a reason for filing a **Paper** return - see Figure 2. Since **Paper** is a terminal state, the system will transfer the tax return from the Activity_Log tab into the Archive tab. The system will highlight the row in pink. See Figure 14.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	4:26 PM		7854	JOE	DOE	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Paper		5 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											
8											
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26											
27											
28											
29											

Reason Required

Reason for Paper

Select a reason:
Identity Protection PIN Issue

And/Or enter free-form explanation:

Submit Cancel

+ ≡ Dashboard ▾ Activity_Log ▾ Incomplete ▾ Archive ▾ Appointments ▾ No Shows ▾

Figure 14 - Paper

Chapter 4 The Post-Filing Process

After the tax return has been electronically filed with the IRS, it is the responsibility of the shift coordinator to make sure that the return was **Accepted** by the IRS and address any return that was **Rejected**. The shift coordinator will be informed through TaxSlayer of acceptance or rejection, typically within 30 minutes of e-filing.

4.1 Handling Accepted Tax Returns

The normal progression of a tax return from an **e-Filed** state is to be **Accepted** by the IRS. This typically happens within 30 minutes of the tax return being e-filed. The shift coordinator, who tracks the tax returns using the TaxSlayer system, will then change the status of the return to **Accepted**. The system will **highlight the row in green**. Since **Accepted** is a terminal state, the system will immediately transfer the tax return from the Activity_Log tab into the Archive tab. See Figure 15.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	4:57 PM		3456	FIONA	GALLAGHER	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Accepted		1 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											
8											
9											
10											
11											
12											
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28											
29											

Figure 15 - Accepted

4.2 Handling IRS Rejection

Occasionally, the IRS will reject an electronic filing of a tax return for a variety of reasons. In that case, the Shift Coordinator will attempt to reach out to the taxpayer to try to resolve any discrepancy. The Shift Coordinator will change the status of the tax return to **Rejected**. The system will then present a dialog requiring entering a reason for the rejection and/or any additional comments. The system will **highlight the row in red**. See Figure 16.

The screenshot displays a web application interface for managing tax returns. A table with columns: Check In Time, Ticket #, SSN Last 4, First Name, Last Name, Tax Year, Counselor, Reviewer, Status, Comments, and Duration. Row 2 shows a rejected return for BEATRICE VANCE, 2026, reviewed by Ms. Reviewer. A modal dialog titled 'Reason Required' is open, asking for a reason for rejection. The 'Reason for Rejected' section has a dropdown menu with 'Affordable Care Act Information Missing' selected. Below it, a text area contains 'Taxpayer did not present form 1095-A'. At the bottom of the dialog are 'Submit' and 'Cancel' buttons. The background interface includes a navigation bar with 'Dashboard', 'Activity_Log', 'Incomplete', 'Archive', 'Appointments', and 'No Shows' tabs.

Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
5:02 PM		7653	BEATRICE	VANCE	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Rejected		1 min

Figure 16 - Rejected

Rejected tax returns will be swept from the Activity Log tab into the Incomplete tab through the End-of-Day process so that the returns can be dealt with in the future.

4.3 The End-of-Day Process

At the conclusion of the daily activities, the Activity_log tab shows only the tax returns that have not yet reached a terminal state. These will be swept by a volunteer-initiated End-of-Day script into the Incomplete tab, from where they can be retrieved for completion in future days. The procedure to initiate the script is:

- Click the "TaxAide Operations" Menu.
- Choose the "Execute End-of-Day Sweep" menu item.
- Confirm by clicking "Yes" on the "Confirm End of Day Process" dialog. See Figure 17.

The script executes the following operations:

- Transfers all of today's incomplete returns from the Activity_Log tab to the Incomplete tab. This clears the Activity_Log tab for next day's operations.
- At Appointment sites - transfers all "no show" appointments to the "No Shows" tab. This clears the Appointments tab for next day's operations.
- Appends text to the comments section of the incomplete tax return [EOD Close {date}] to help identify when the taxpayer was last seen at the site.

	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	Check In Time	Ticket #	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments	Duration
2	5:02 PM		7653	BEATRICE	VANCE	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Rejected	Affordable Care Act Information Missing. Taxpayer did not	19 min
3											
4											
5											
6											
7											
8											
9											
10											
11											
12											
13											
14											
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29											
30											

Confirm End of Day Process

This operation will:

- * Transfer all today's incomplete returns from the Activity Log sheet to the Incomplete sheet

If the site operates by appointment, this operation will also:

- * Clear the Appointment sheet, and
- * Transfer the 'no shows' taxpayers to the No Show sheet

Do you want to proceed?

No Yes

+ ≡ Dashboard ▾

Activity_Log ▾

Incomplete ▾

Archive ▾

Appointments ▾

No Shows ▾

<

Figure 17 - End of Day Process

Chapter 5: Continuing Incomplete Tax Returns

After the End-of-Day process was completed, **Incomplete** tax returns will be stored in the Incomplete tab. When a taxpayer returns to the site to complete their tax return, the greeter will search for the record using any of the filters of the Incomplete tab's column. See Figure 18.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	Transfer to Activity Log	Check In Date/Time	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments
2	☐	7/22/2026	6666	FIONA	GALLAGHER	2026	Mr. Counselor		Ready for Review	[EOD Close 07/22] Ran out of time
3	☐	7/22/2026	5555	EVAN	MONTGOMERY	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	In Review	[EOD Close 07/22] Ran out of time
4	☐	7/22/2026	4444	DIANA	CRUZ	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Incomplete	[EOD Close 07/22] Missing documents, 1099-B from brokerage
5	☒	7/22/2026	1111	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Rejected	[EOD Close 07/22] Affordable Care Act Information Missing, Taxpayer missing 1095-A
6										
7										
8										
9										

Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows Settings

Figure 18 - The Incomplete Tab

The greeter will then click the "Transfer to Activity Log" checkbox to transfer the tax return to the Activity_Log tab. The system will confirm that the incomplete tax return record was transferred to the Activity Log tab, listing the taxpayer's name, the counselor who previously worked on this tax return, the date the taxpayer was previously at the site and any comments that were previously added to the record. The system will also assign the tax return ticket number 99 to indicate that this is a returning taxpayer. From this point the incomplete tax return is processed normally. See Figure 19.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	Transfer to Activity Log	Check In Date/Time	SSN Last 4	First Name	Last Name	Tax Year	Counselor	Reviewer	Status	Comments
2	☐	7/22/2026	6666	FIONA	GALLAGHER	2026	Mr. Counselor		Ready for Review	[EOD Close 07/22] Ran out of time
3	☐	7/22/2026	5555	EVAN	MONTGOMERY	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	In Review	[EOD Close 07/22] Ran out of time
4	☒	7/22/2026	1111	ARTHUR	PENDELTON	2026	Mr. Counselor	Ms. Reviewer	Rejected	[EOD Close 07/22] Affordable Care Act Information Missing, Taxpayer missing 1095-A
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Dashboard Activity_Log Incomplete Archive Appointments No Shows Settings

Transferred Tax Return to Activity_Log

Name: DIANA CRUZ
 Previously counseled by: Mr. Counselor
 Current status: Incomplete
 Comments: [Reactivated 07/22] [EOD Close 07/22] Missing documents, 1099-B from brokerage

OK

Figure 19 - Transfer Incomplete Record to Activity Log Tab

Chapter 6: The Archive Tab

All tax return records that reached a terminal state are archived in the Archive tab. These include tax returns that were:

- e-Filed and **Approved** by the IRS
- Produced as **Paper** returns
- **Deactivated** tax returns.
- **No Return** taxpayer interactions.

The archive serves as the database underlying the site's Dashboard and can be sorted by any of the columns.

Chapter 7: The No Shows Tab

The End-of-Day process transfers all appointments for which taxpayers at an appointment site were scheduled an failed to show up. See Figure 20.

	A	B	C	D
1	Appointment Date / Time	First Name	Last Name	Phone Number
2	7/22/2026 14:30	GEORGE	BROOKS	(941) 555-0119
3	7/22/2026 14:45	HANNAH	ABBOTT	(407) 555-0164
4	7/22/2026 15:00	IAN	MALCOLM	(813) 555-0138
5				

Figure 20 - The No Show Tab

Section 7: The Dashboard

TBD